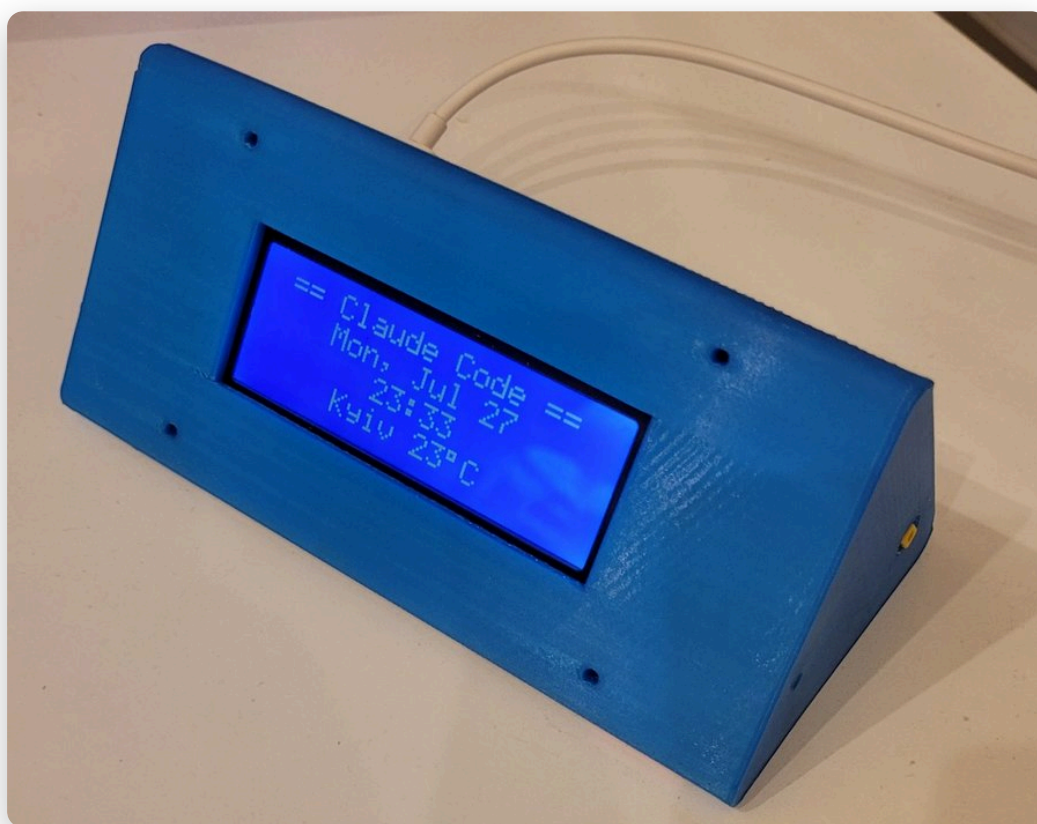


CLAUDIUS I

Hardware status indicator for Claude Code
User Guide



Plainstack technologies · Chaos into systems.
2026

1. What Claudius I is

Claudius I is a desktop device that shows, in real time, what Claude Code is doing on your computer. One glance at the screen tells you whether Claude is free, working, has asked a question, or is waiting for a permission. The device also shows your plan-usage limit, a clock with local weather, and — for cities in Ukraine — air-raid alerts with an audible siren.

The screen is a classic 20×4 character LCD (HD44780). Every screen mock-up in this guide is drawn with the very same 5×8-dot character generator the physical display itself uses.

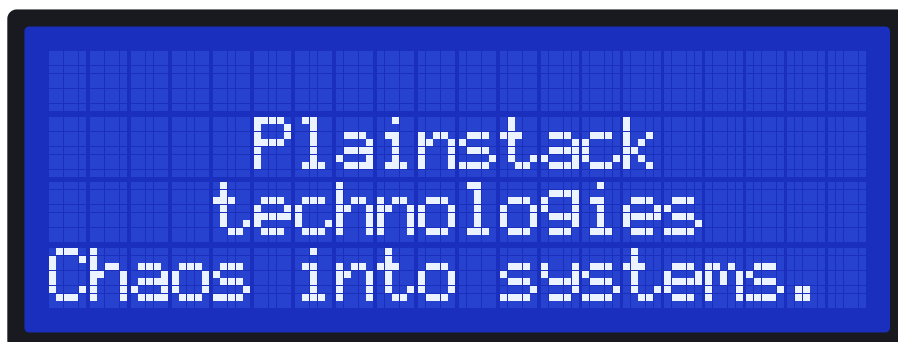
2. What's in the box, and requirements

- the Claudius I device;
- a USB-C cable that carries data (not power-only);
- a USB drive with the installer and this guide.

What your computer needs:

- Windows 10/11, Linux, or macOS 11+;
- Claude Code installed and logged in (<https://claude.com/claude-code> — run it at least once and sign in *before* setting up the device).

Plug the device into your computer with the USB-C cable — the screen lights up, shows a boot splash, then the clock. No separate power adapter is needed; any USB port works, the device is found automatically.



Boot splash screen

3. Installing the software

3.1. Windows — 5 minutes

1. Plug in the device with the USB-C cable and insert the USB drive.
2. Open the `ClaudeStatus` folder on the drive.
3. Right-click `setup.ps1` → *Run with PowerShell*. If that's blocked by policy, open PowerShell in this folder and run two lines instead:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass  
.\setup.ps1
```

4. The installer takes it from there:
 - installs Python 3 if it's missing;

- replaces an incompatible USB driver if needed (this may show **one** administrator confirmation — accept it);
- flashes the latest firmware onto the device;
- opens a setup wizard in your browser: pick your city on the map (for weather and alerts), set brightness and sound preferences.

5. Once it says *Installation complete*, open any terminal and run `claude` — the screen starts updating.

3.2. Linux / macOS — 5 minutes

1. Plug in the device. No driver is needed: Linux has one built into the kernel, macOS 11+ ships one with the OS.
2. Copy the `ClaudeStatus` folder from the drive to your computer, open a terminal in it, and run: `bash setup.sh`
3. The script installs python3, pyserial and avrdude through your package manager (it may ask for your sudo password), flashes the device, and asks the same questions in the terminal: city, brightness, sounds.
4. On Linux you'll be added to the `dialout` group — that becomes permanent after you log out and back in, but the installer also grants temporary access right away, so everything works without a re-login.
5. Run `claude` in a terminal.

3.3. Changing settings, and uninstalling

- To change city, brightness, or sounds — just run the installer again; the device will remember the new settings.
- Brightness can also be changed without the wizard: `python b1.py 50` (0–100) from the app folder.
- Full removal: `uninstall.ps1` (Windows) or `bash uninstall.sh` (Linux/macOS) from the `ClaudeStatus` folder.

3.4. Installer options (optional)

The installer can be run with flags — useful if something wasn't detected automatically, or if you want to skip the interactive wizard:

Windows (<code>setup.ps1</code>)	Linux / macOS (<code>setup.sh</code>)	Effect
<code>-Port COM7</code>	<code>--port /dev/ttyUSB0</code>	set the device port manually instead of auto-detecting
<code>-City "Berlin"</code>	— (city is asked in the terminal)	set the city without the interactive wizard
<code>-NoWeather</code>	<code>--no-weather</code>	disable weather and air-raid alerts entirely
<code>-NoAutostart</code>	<code>--no-autostart</code>	don't add a background auto-start entry at login

Example: `.\setup.ps1 -City "Kyiv" -NoAutostart` or `bash setup.sh --no-weather`.

3.5. What gets installed, and where

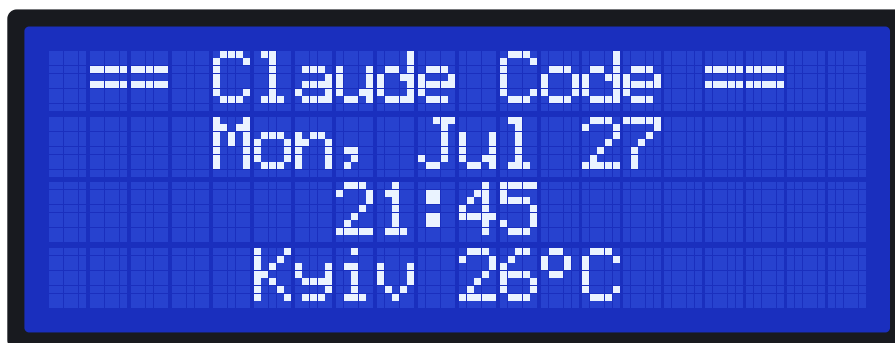
Component	Windows	Linux / macOS
App files	%LOCALAPPDATA%\ClaudeStatus\app	~/.local/share/claude-status/app
Claude Code hooks	~/.claude/settings.json (an existing file is backed up first)	
Autostart	Task Scheduler entry «ClaudeStatusDaemon»	systemd user service (Linux) / LaunchAgent (macOS)
Log file	%TEMP%\claude_lcd_daemon.log	/tmp/claude_lcd_daemon.log
Python 3, pyserial, avrdude	installed automatically if missing	

For the curious: technical details and architecture live in `readme.txt` and `ClaudeStatus/README.md` on the drive. For installation and everyday use, this guide is all you need.

4. Screens and states

4.1. Clock (idle screensaver)

Shown while Claude Code isn't running, and also after 5 minutes of inactivity: time, date, city and temperature (refreshed once a minute). Any activity from Claude immediately restores the working screen.



Clock with date and weather

4.2. IDLE — Claude is free

A Claude Code session is open with no task running. The bottom row shows your 5-hour plan-usage percentage and the time until it resets (the same numbers shown on `claude.ai` → Usage).



Idle state with the usage line

4.3. WORKING — Claude is working

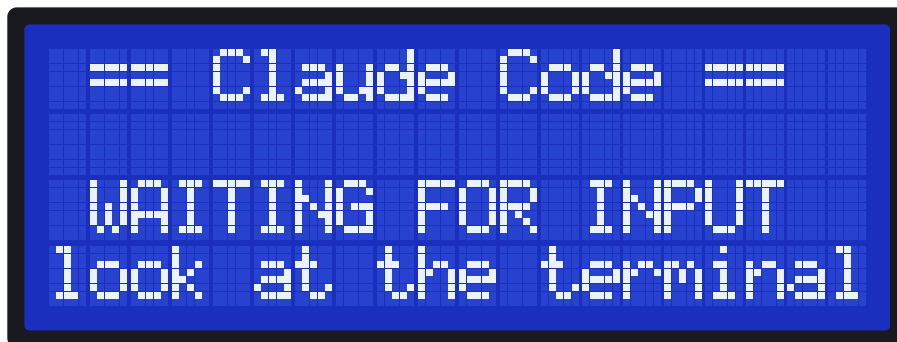
The top row shows the name of the project (folder) Claude is working in. The center shows a "verb" describing the work, matching Claude Code's own animated label (a different one each time). The bottom row is the 5-hour usage bar.



Working on project "my-project", 42% of the limit used

4.4. WAITING FOR INPUT — Claude is waiting for a reply

Claude has asked a question in the terminal. The device plays a short rising chirp; a message longer than 20 characters scrolls as a marquee, and the backlight switches to full brightness for the duration to draw your attention.



Waiting for the user's reply

4.5. PERMISSION? — a permission request

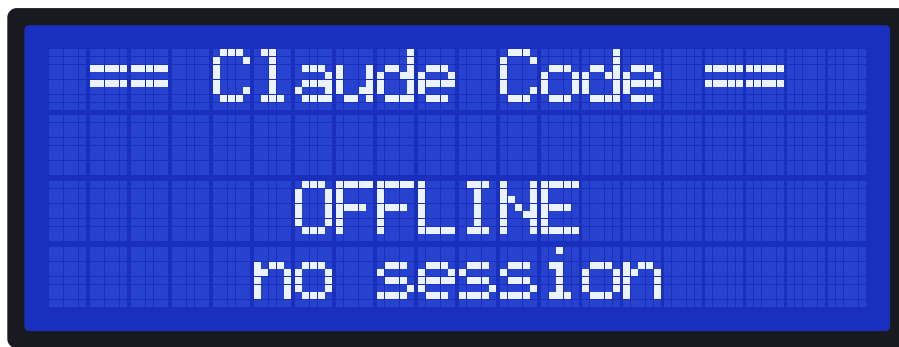
Claude is asking permission for an action (running a command, editing a file, etc). A distinct sound plays. As soon as you answer in the terminal and Claude continues, the screen returns to WORKING on its own.



Requesting permission to run a command

4.6. OFFLINE — no session

No running Claude Code session was found. Run `claude` in a terminal — the state changes automatically.



Claude Code isn't running

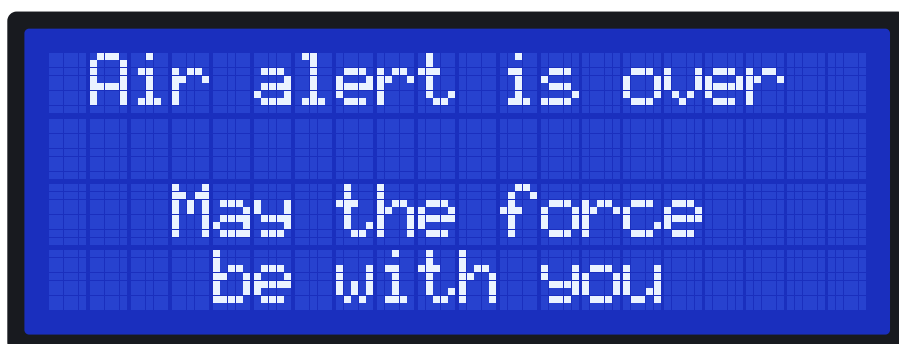
4.7. Air-raid alert (for cities in Ukraine)

If a city in Ukraine is selected in the settings, the device watches for air-raid alerts in your oblast through open public feeds (no accounts or keys needed). A siren plays and a warning screen appears the moment an alert starts.



Air-raid alert screen

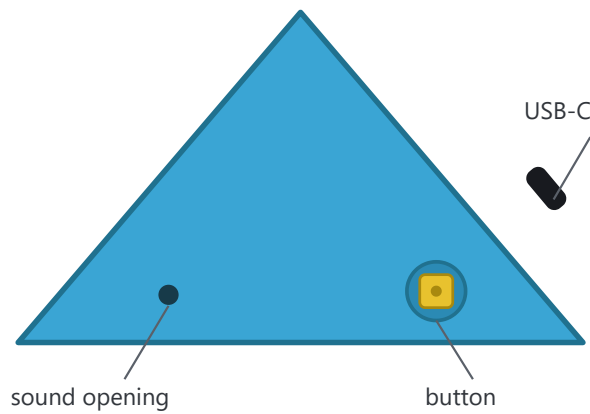
Pressing the button dismisses the alert screen (the sound won't repeat), but while the alert is still active, the top row keeps flashing `AIR RAID ALERT` as a reminder. A short melody plays once the all-clear comes:



Air-raid all-clear

5. The button

There is a button on the right side face of the enclosure; to its left is a sound opening (don't cover it). The USB-C connector sits near the back edge.



The device's right side face (schematic)

- **Press** — turn the display off or on. When the display is off, all sounds are muted too.
- **During an alert** — a press dismisses the alert screen.
- **If the screen went dark** (e.g. after the computer went to sleep) — a press brings it back.

6. Sound signals

Event	Sound
Claude finished working	falling fifth (A → D)
Claude is waiting for a reply	rising fifth (D → A)
Permission request	a distinct short pattern
75% of the limit used (5-hour / 7-day)	double warning chirp
90% of the limit used	triple cascade
Air-raid alert starts	siren
Alert all-clear	major arpeggio

Sounds can be turned off in the setup wizard (re-run the installer), or temporarily by turning off the display with the button.

7. Display automation

- The screen blanks together with your computer's monitors and wakes up with them — on Windows, macOS, and Linux (X11 and GNOME are supported on Linux).
- After 5 minutes in IDLE, the clock screensaver turns on.
- The backlight temporarily switches to full brightness during a marquee-scrolling message (see section 4.4).
- Time and date are synced from your computer automatically on every connection.

8. If something isn't working

Symptom	What to do
Screen is dark	Check that the USB-C cable carries data (not charge-only); try another port; press the button.
States aren't updating	Make sure Claude Code is running (<code>cclaude</code> in a terminal). Check the log at <code>%TEMP%\cclaude_lcd_daemon.log</code> (Windows) or <code>/tmp/cclaude_lcd_daemon.log</code> .
"Device not functioning" during setup (Windows)	Re-run <code>setup.ps1</code> — it replaces the incompatible CH340 driver with the working v3.4 from the drive.
Port "busy" or won't open	Unplug and re-plug the USB-C cable — the device is found automatically.

9. Technical specifications

Controller	Arduino Nano (ATmega328P)
Display	20×4 character LCD (HD44780) over I ² C, 5×8-dot character generator
Button	mechanical, on the right side face of the enclosure
Sound	piezo buzzer
Clock	synced from the computer automatically
Connection	USB-C (power + data)
Compatibility	Windows 10/11, Linux, macOS 11+